



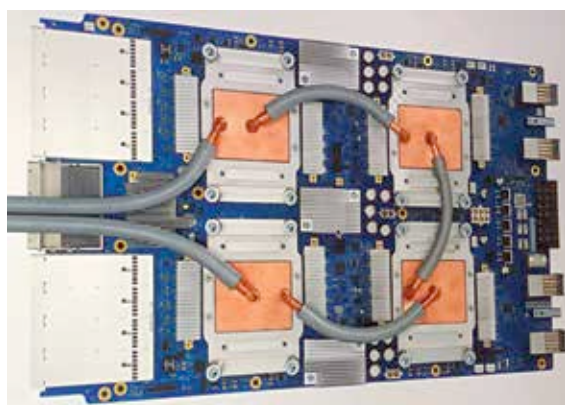
Twitter shuts Brussels office

The office had been in contact with the Euro Commission, helping them formulate their online policies. <https://digit.in/dec22-37>



AIIMS suffers cyberattack

As a result, the premier institute had suffered power outages all through to the next day. <https://digit.in/dec22-38>



In your head?

fed into your digital brain via an external program. It fed sensory inputs into your brain to digitally provide you with the experience of the world you were living in.

This is one of the few ways humanity will survive the climate catastrophe when it comes about. Leaving the economically weaker sections of society back on a dying Earth left to fend for themselves like pre-historic humans. But it is not all sunshine and roses for the people who upload their consciousnesses.

Here's a short story as a thought experiment. There was a Greek King called Theseus, who was victorious in battle. He sailed from Athens to Delos as a mark of victory. The people of

Athens marked this as a momentous voyage to commemorate this victory. They sailed his ship to Delos every year, which came to be known as the Ship of Theseus. As the years went by, the ritual of ship sailing continued. The ship started breaking down from age and needed some parts replaced. Over the years, most of its

original wood structures had gone through enough wear and tear and broken down that it was all replaced by new wood structures. As the Ship of Theseus ritual ceremonies continued through centuries, some ancient philosophers pondered this monumental question: After several centuries of maintenance, if every part of the Ship of Theseus had been replaced, one at a time, was it still the same ship?

Similarly, when you replace your consciousness with a copy of your brain uploaded into the cloud. Will it still be you existing and experiencing all the wonders a digitally generated universe in the cloud can offer? Or, did you just commit a self-

inflicted murder or a suicide, and the consciousness up in the cloud is an alien someone else, which you are not experiencing?

Similarly, extrapolating this to real life. Every night you go to sleep, your brain undergoes a maintenance process. It cleans up your brain of cellular waste byproducts that may have accumulated in the interstitial spaces and in the brain cells. It decides which memories to shelve for long-term storage and which short-term ones to discard, like the meal you had a few days back. Your brain undergoes constant change and upkeep every time you sleep. You will often notice how you, as a person, have changed over the years. Your values and aspirations may evolve through time. Does that mean you are not the same person you were a decade ago? Who are you? Are you even the same person that you were yesterday? Or are you a person who is being slowly changed every night as you sleep and age through time?

Does this mean your younger self no longer exists? You might retain vague memories of your younger-self, but are you experiencing the same consciousness that your younger-self experienced? Or are you just a new alien consciousness being housed in a brain with memories of your younger-self tricking you into thinking you are all the same person?

These questions are very much uncharted territories of science and philosophy. No one knows the answers yet. The Human Connectome Project (HCP), similar to The Human Genome Project, is underway with the ambitious goal of building a network map (connectome) of the entire human brain. We might gain better insights into these questions once we have a complete human connectome map to analyze and study. Significant leaps in the philosophies of human consciousness must also be made for us to come anywhere near answering these questions. Until then, only time will tell. 

Reading Material: <https://digit.in/RMC>



That counts as a W?